

Top 10 FOSS Security Tools to Protect Your System

In a very insecure world, security tools to safeguard your system are absolutely necessary. FOSS offers a large selection of these tools, mostly free of cost. So go ahead and select the tools you need to secure your system from the list provided.



There are lots of tools available in the market to help individuals or network administrators secure their systems. Some tools are paid for, while others are free and open source. The tools given below are those that are FOSS based and highly popular because of their offensive or defensive capabilities.

People who want to learn ethical hacking can try some of these tools to find out the loopholes and vulnerabilities in their systems or networks.

1. Nmap

Nmap (Network Mapper) is a free and open source utility for network discovery and audit. It is used to map your network and ports. It also has scripts that can detect network related issues. Nmap fetches raw data and determines the host type, OS type and hosts available in the network.

For more information on how to download and use this utility, go to <https://nmap.org/>

2. OSSEC

This is a free and open source host-based intrusion detection

system (HIDS), which is very easy to set up and use. It can provide security alerts that even we can write scripts for, to serve different purposes. We can add more capabilities by tweaking the source code.

Here is the official site for OSSEC: <http://ossec.github.io/>

3. Security Onion

This is a defensive Debian based Linux security distribution for network security monitoring. It is used for intrusion detection and for log management purposes. It acts like an army commander and contains different tools like Snort, OSSEC, Squert, NetworkMiner, ELSA, etc, for defence.

Here is the link that you can download Security Onion from: <https://securityonion.net/>

4. OpenVAS

This is a free and open source vulnerability managing and scanning suite. It's a fork of the Nessus engine, which continues development on the open source project. It has a Web based dashboard.